

California Regional Water Quality Control Board
Santa Ana Region

August 28, 1998

ITEM:

SUBJECT: Waste Discharge Requirements for Lake Hemet Municipal Water District, Hemet, Riverside County, Order No. 98-84

DISCUSSION:

Lake Hemet Municipal Water District operates a wastewater treatment plant in the Lake Hemet area of Riverside County. The discharges from the facility are currently regulated under Order No. 87-41. The waste discharge requirements need to be updated to reflect changes in state laws, regulations, plans, and policies.

Approximately 35,000 gallons per day of treated wastewater are currently discharged to three evaporation/percolation ponds located in a portion of Section 9, T6S, R3E, SBB&M. The design capacity of the treatment facility is 100,000 gallons per day. The wastewater treatment plant consists of an aeration lagoon, a settling tank, and three evaporation/percolation ponds. A new aeration basin, situated north of the existing aeration basin, is currently under construction. The location of the treatment facility is shown in Attachment "A".

The evaporation/percolation ponds overlie the Garner Valley Groundwater Subbasin, the beneficial uses of which include municipal and domestic supply, and agricultural supply. Surface drainage in the area is tributary to Lake Hemet, the beneficial uses of which include municipal and domestic supply, agricultural supply, groundwater recharge, non-contact water recreation, water contact recreation, warm freshwater habitat, wildlife habitat, hydropower generation, cold freshwater habitat, and spawning, reproduction & development.

The discharge limitations of the proposed order are based on the Water Quality Control Plan (Basin Plan) for the Santa Ana Region and best professional judgement. These limitations are intended to meet the water quality objectives established in the Basin Plan to protect both surface water and groundwater and to ensure that the discharge will not create conditions of pollution or nuisance.

RECOMMENDATION:

Adopt Order No. 98-84 as presented.

COMMENTS SOLICITATION:

Comments were solicited from the discharger and from the following agencies:

State Water Resources Control Board, Office of the Chief Counsel - Ted Cobb

State Water Resources Control Board, Division of Water Quality - John Youngerman

State Department of Water Resources - Glendale

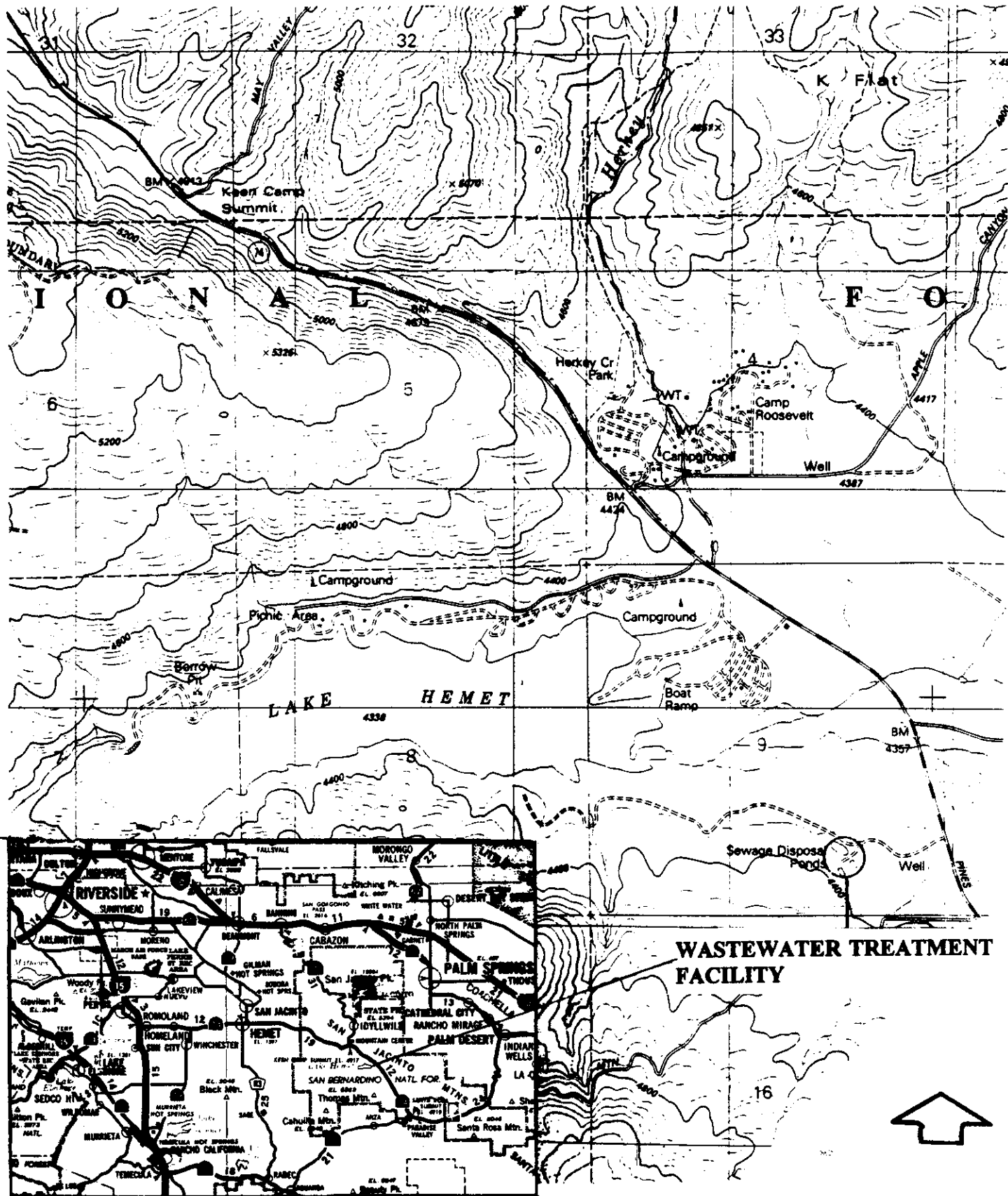
State Department of Health Services - San Diego

Riverside County Department of Environmental Health Services - John Silva

Riverside County Department of Building and Safety - Tom Ingram

Riverside County Flood Control and Water Conservation District - Mark Wills

Idyllwild Water District - Thomas Lovejoy



California Regional Water Quality Control Board
Santa Ana Region

ORDER NO. 98-84

Waste Discharge Requirements
for
Lake Hemet Municipal Water District
Riverside County

The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Santa Ana Region (hereinafter Regional Board), finds that:

1. On April 10, 1987, the Regional Board adopted Order No. 87-41 for the discharge of treated municipal wastewater from Lake Hemet Municipal Water District (hereinafter discharger) campground facility to evaporation/percolation ponds in the Lake Hemet area of Riverside County.
2. The current waste discharge requirements need to be updated to reflect changes in state laws, regulations, plans, and policies.
3. The wastewater treatment plant consists of an aeration lagoon, a settling tank, and three evaporation/percolation ponds. The design capacity of the treatment facility is 100,000 gallons per day. An average of approximately 35,000 gallons per day of treated wastewater are currently discharged to the evaporation/percolation ponds. The evaporation/percolation ponds are located in a portion of Section 9, T6S, R3E, SBB&M.
4. A revised Water Quality Control Plan for the Santa Ana River Basin (Basin Plan) became effective on January 24, 1995. The Basin Plan contains beneficial uses and water quality objectives for waters in the Santa Ana Region.
5. The evaporation/percolation ponds overlie the Garner Valley Ground Water Subbasin, the beneficial uses of which include:
 - a. Municipal and domestic supply, and
 - b. Agricultural supply
6. Surface drainage in the area is tributary to Lake Hemet, the beneficial uses of which include:
 - a. Municipal and domestic Supply,
 - b. Agricultural supply,

- c. Groundwater recharge,
 - d. Non-contact water recreation,
 - e. Water contact recreation,
 - f. Warm freshwater habitat,
 - g. Wildlife habitat
 - h. Hydropower generation,
 - i. Cold freshwater habitat, and
 - j. Spawning, reproduction, and development
7. The requirements contained in this order are necessary to meet the water quality objectives and protect the beneficial uses specified in the Basin Plan.
 8. The project involves the continued operation of an existing facility and, as such, is exempt from the California Environmental Quality Act (Public Resources Code, Section 21100 et. seq) in accordance with Section 15301, Chapter 3, Title 14, California Code of Regulations.
 9. The Regional Board has notified the discharger and other interested agencies and persons of its intent to prescribe waste discharge requirements for the discharge and has provided them with an opportunity to submit their written views and recommendations.
 10. The Board, in a public meeting, heard and considered all comments pertaining to the discharge.

IT IS HEREBY ORDERED that the discharger, in order to meet the provisions contained in Division 7 of the California Water Code and regulations adopted thereunder and the provisions of the Clean Water Act and regulations and guidelines adopted thereunder, shall comply with the following:

A. Discharge Prohibitions:

1. The discharge of wastes to property not owned or controlled by the discharger is prohibited.
2. The discharge of highly mineralized wastes to the ground is prohibited.
3. Odors, vectors, and other nuisances of sewage origin are prohibited outside of the treatment plant site or ponds.
4. The discharge of any substances in concentrations toxic to human, animal, plant or aquatic life is prohibited
5. The discharge to any pond with less than 18 inches of freeboard is prohibited.

B. Discharge Specifications:

1. The discharge of wastes containing a monthly average Biochemical Oxygen Demand (BOD) constituent concentration in excess of 45 mg/l is prohibited.
- 2.a. The discharge of wastes containing an annual average total dissolved solids (TDS) constituent concentration in excess of 500 mg/l is prohibited.
- 2.b. The discharge of wastes containing an annual average TDS concentration which exceeds the annual average TDS concentration in the water supply by more than 250 mg/l is prohibited.

For Discharge Specifications 2.a. and 2.b., whichever limitation results in the lower average TDS concentration shall be controlling.

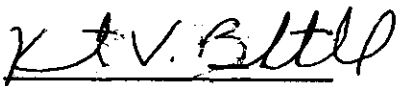
3. The pH of the discharge shall at all times be within the range of 6.5 and 8.5 pH units.

C. Provisions:

1. The discharger shall comply with Monitoring and Reporting Program No. 98-84 as ordered by the Executive Officer of the Regional Board. This monitoring and reporting program may be modified by the Executive Officer at any time during the term of this order, and may include a reduction or an increase in the number of parameters to be monitored, the frequency of the monitoring, or the number and size of samples collected..
2. Neither the treatment nor the discharge of wastes shall cause or threaten to cause a nuisance or pollution as defined in Section 13050 of the California Water Code.
3. The treatment and disposal facilities shall be protected from a 100-year frequency flood.
4. The discharger shall file with the Board a report of waste discharge at least 120 days before making any material change or proposed change in the character, location, or volume of the discharge or in the operator or property ownership of any portions of the facility identified in this order.
5. The discharger shall maintain a copy of this order at the site so that it is available at all times to site operating personnel. Key operating personnel shall be familiar with its contents.
6. Collected screenings, sludge, and other solids removed from liquid wastes shall be disposed of in a manner approved by the Executive Officer.

7. The discharger shall at all times properly operate and maintain all facilities and systems of treatment and control (and related appurtenances) which are installed or used by the discharger to achieve compliance with the conditions of this order. Proper operation and maintenance also includes adequate laboratory controls, appropriate quality assurance procedures, effective performance, adequate funding, adequate staffing and training and adequate process controls. This provision requires the operation of back up or auxiliary facilities or similar systems which are installed by a discharger only when the operation is necessary to achieve compliance with the conditions of the order.
8. Whenever the discharger monitors any pollutant more frequently than is required by this order, the results of this monitoring shall be included in the calculation and reporting of the data submitted in the discharge monitoring report specified by the Executive Officer.
9. The requirements prescribed herein do not authorize the commission of any act causing injury to the property of another, nor protect the discharger from his liabilities under federal, state, or local laws.
10. This order does not convey any property rights of any sort, or any exclusive privilege.
11. The Regional Board, and other authorized representatives shall be allowed:
 - a. Entry upon premises where a regulated facility or activity is located or conducted, or where records are kept under the conditions of this order;
 - b. Access to copy any records that are kept under the conditions of the order;
 - c. To inspect any facility, equipment (including monitoring and control equipment), practices, or operations regulated or required under this order; and
 - d. To photograph, sample and monitor for the purpose of assuring compliance with this order.
12. The discharger shall take all reasonable steps to minimize or prevent any discharge that has a reasonable likelihood of adversely affecting human health or the environment.
13. The discharger shall take all reasonable steps to minimize any adverse impact to receiving waters resulting from noncompliance with any requirement specified in this order, including such accelerated or additional monitoring as necessary to determine the nature and impact of the noncomplying discharge.
14. Order No. 87-41 is hereby rescinded.

I, Gerard J. Thibeault, Executive Officer, do hereby certify that the foregoing is a full, true, and correct copy of an order adopted by the California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Santa Ana Region, on August 28, 1998.


for Gerard J. Thibeault
Executive Officer

California Regional Water Quality Control Board
Santa Ana Region

Monitoring and Reporting Program No. 98-84

for
Lake Hemet Municipal Water District
Riverside County

A. General Monitoring Provisions:

1. Records of monitoring information shall include:
 - a. The date, exact place, and time of sampling or measurements;
 - b. The individual(s) who performed the sampling or measurements;
 - c. The date(s) analyses were performed;
 - d. The analytical techniques or methods used; and
 - e. The results of such analyses.
2. All monitoring instruments and devices used by the discharger to fulfill the prescribed monitoring program shall be properly maintained and calibrated as necessary to ensure their continued accuracy.
3. The flow measurement system shall be calibrated at least once per year or more frequently, to ensure continued accuracy.
4. All analyses shall be conducted at a laboratory certified for such analyses by the State Department of Health Services or at a laboratory approved by the Executive Officer of the Regional Board.

B. Definition::

1. A "grab" sample is defined as any individual sample collected at peak flows in less than 15 minutes.

C. Effluent Monitoring:

1. A sampling station shall be established at the point of discharge and shall be located where representative samples of the effluent can be obtained.

2. During the months of April, May, June, July, August, and September, representative samples of the effluent from the final effluent pond shall be collected and analyzed for the following:

Constituent	Unit	Type of Sample	Minimum Frequency of Sampling
Total Dissolved Solids	mg/l	Grab	Monthly
Biochemical Oxygen Demand	"	"	Weekly
pH	pH units	"	"

- 2.a. When there is a discharge of wastes during the months of October, November, December, January, February, and March, representative samples of effluent shall be collected once per month and analyzed for the constituents specified under Effluent Monitoring C.2, above.
3. Weekly samples shall be collected on a representative day of the week.
4. Monthly samples shall be collected on the fifth working day of the month.
5. The daily flow to the ponds shall be determined and recorded in a permanent log book.
6. Every Monday, the freeboard in each pond shall be measured and entered in a permanent log book.

D. Water Supply Monitoring:

At least once annually, in July, a sample of the water supply to the area sewered to the treatment plant shall be collected and shall be analyzed for total dissolved solids.

E. Reporting:

1. Monitoring reports shall be submitted by the 30th day of the month following sampling and shall include:
- A copy of the chemical analyses;
 - Records of daily effluent flow to the ponds;
 - Weekly ponds freeboard data;
 - Number of visitor-days during the monitoring period;
 - Water supply analyses; and
 - A statement regarding the maintenance of all wastes on property owned and controlled by the discharger.

2. For every item where the requirements are not met, the discharger shall submit a statement of the actions undertaken or proposed which will bring the discharge into full compliance with the requirements at the earliest time and submit a timetable for correction.
3. All reports shall be signed by a responsible officer of Lake Hemet Municipal Water District and shall be submitted under penalty of perjury.

Gerard J. Thibeault
for Gerard J. Thibeault
Executive Officer

August 28, 1998